

Daniel Sánchez-García

PhD in Biology

Doñana Biological Station - EBD-CSIC - Seville (Spain)

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Professional experience

Postdoctoral Researcher

Doñana Biological Station (EBD-CSIC), Department of Conservation Biology and Global Change, Seville (Spain) — Jan 2025 - present

Specialist in ant species identification

Doñana Biological Station (EBD-CSIC), Department of Conservation Biology and Global Change, Seville (Spain) — May 2024 - Jun 2024

- Identification of ant species from pitfall trap samples from Spain, France, Belgium and the Netherlands, contributing to ecological research and biodiversity assessments through taxonomic expertise.

Education

PhD in Biology

Museum and Institute of Zoology, Polish Academy of Sciences, Warsaw (Poland) — Oct 2019 - Sep 2024

- PhD Thesis: The project aimed to get a better understanding of how reintroductions of parasites work, we performed a multi-level comparison of source and reintroduced populations of *Phengaris teleius* by studying 1) population genetics, 2) morphology of adult butterflies and 3) behavioural, chemical and acoustical adaptations of butterfly caterpillar to the *Myrmica* host ants.

MSc in Biodiversity and Conservation Biology

Universidad Pablo de Olavide, Seville (Spain) — Oct 2017 - Jul 2018

- MSc Thesis (Thesis grade: 9.8/10 - Honors with Distinction): The work aimed to study the effect of temperature over ant assemblages from different habitats, applying different ecological perspectives. Taxonomic and functional diversity were studied, and a new index was developed to study the direct effect of temperature over the interspecific competition.

BSc in Biology

Universitat de València, Valencia (Spain) — Sep 2012 - Sep 2016

- BSc thesis (Thesis grade: 9.5/10): The work aimed to provide new knowledge about the ant communities of Sierra de Javalambre. The main goals were: 1) study how ant species are distributed along the altitudinal gradient, studying variables like ground temperature, nest density and stone density; 2) study the patching effect of *Juniperus sabina* over ant activity and nesting areas.

Research stays

Prof. Luca Pietro Casacci

University of Turin, Department of Life Sciences and Systems Biology, Turin (Italy) — Oct 2021

- I received training in recording insect vibroacoustic signals, sonogram analysis and performing behavioral assays, which enhanced my skills in experimental design and data interpretation.

Prof. Patrizia d'Ettorre

Sorbonne Paris North University, Laboratory of Experimental and Comparative Ethology, Paris (France) — Jan 2020 - Feb 2020

- I received training in GC-MS analysis of cuticular hydrocarbons and bioinformatics workflows, which deepened my understanding of chemical communication in social insects and enhanced my analytical skills.

Internships

Scientific assistant

Valencian Institute of Agricultural Research (IVIA), Department of Entomology, Valencia (Spain) — Feb 2016 - May 2016

- Internship with the researcher Alejandro Tena working on a biological control applied study about the effect of the presence of the ant *Lasius grandis* on the behaviour of the parasitoid wasp *Anagyrus pseudococci* on mealybug colonies of *Planococcus citri* (pest of citrus).

Environmental manager

Agricultural, Stockbreeding and Environmental Public Service, Government of Aragón, Teruel (Spain) — Jul 2015 - Sep 2015

- Internship with the environmental manager José Manuel González working on environmental impact reports; monitoring of fish river population dynamic for its management and conservation using electric fishing techniques; monitoring of deer population dynamic for its management and conservation in the National Hunting Reserve "Montes Universales"; management and translocation of native plant species.

Publications

Note: Showing only the 5 most recent publications. For a complete list of peer-reviewed publications and manuscripts, please refer to my *Google Scholar profile* or *personal website*.

Ambakina, H., Gómez, K., Monzenga, J.-C., **Sánchez-García, D.**, & Dekoninck, W. (2026). Uncovering ant diversity across forest successional stages in the yangambi biosphere reserve (DRC): Insights from winkler and pitfall trap sampling. *African Invertebrates*, *67*(1), 65–91. https://doi.org/10.3897/afrinvertebr.67.180461

Sánchez-García, D., Cerdá, X., & Angulo, E. (2026). Temperature and management reduce the abundance of the invasive argentine ant (Linepithema humile). *bioRxiv*. https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.10.08.756264

Sánchez-García, D., Wynhoff, I., d'Ettorre, P., Leroy, C., Kajzer-Bonk, J., Maák, I. E., Barbero, F., Casacci, L. P., & Witek, M. (2025). Ongoing coevolution between reintroduced Phengaris teleius butterflies and their Myrmica host ants. *bioRxiv*. https://doi.org/10.64898/2025.12.02.691951

Sánchez-García, D., Wynhoff, I., Kajzer-Bonk, J., Sztencel-Jabłonka, A., Nowicki, P., Casacci, L. P., & Witek, M. (2024). Temporal and spatial variation of morphological traits and genetic structure in Phengaris teleius myrmecophilous butterflies following habitat and climate changes three decades after reintroduction. *Global Ecology and Conservation*, *54*, e03104. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gecco.2024.e03104

Trigos-Peral, G., Maák, I. E., Schmid, S., Chudzik, P., Czaczkes, T. J., Witek, M., Casacci, L. P., **Sánchez-García, D.**, Lőrincz, Á., Kochanowski, M., & Heinze, J. (2024). Urban abiotic stressors drive changes in the foraging activity and colony growth of the black garden ant Lasius niger. *Science of The Total Environment*, *915*, 170157. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2024.170157

Conference talks and posters

I have presented my research as oral talks and posters in **13** national and international conferences. For a list of presentations, *click here* to download my full cv.

Funding

2022 - 2025	PRELUDIUM grant 2021/41/N/NZ8/04360 (NCN, Poland). Bacteria – ant – plant interaction: the effect of ants as bacteria dispersal vectors and indirect drivers of plant health.	*202,001 PLN (≈ 46,000 €)*

Awards

2025	Best oral presentation at the XIX International Congress of the Spanish Society of Ethology and Evolutionary Ecology (Seville, Spain)

Reviews

Manuscripts reviewed for: Applied and Environmental Microbiology (1), Insect Conservation and Diversity (2), Arthropod-Plant Interactions (1), Polish Journal of Ecology (1)

Courses

2025	Systematic Reviews and Meta-analysis in R
2025	Optimizing the use of R for ecological analyses
2019	Advanced University Course in Ecological Network Analysis
2018	Animal Tracking Course